Leena Morris

Southern New Hampshire University

CS 250: Software Development Lifecycle

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Sprint Review and Retrospective

Throughout this course, I learned how important each Scrum role is when developing software. Before taking this class, I didn't really understand how much teamwork went into a software project. I mostly thought developers were responsible for writing code and making sure the program worked. After working through the SNHU Travel project, I realized that everyone has different responsibilities that help the team stay organized.

The Product Owner was responsible for understanding what the customer wanted and making sure the team focused on the most important features. The Scrum Master helped the team follow the Scrum process and worked to remove problems that could slow down development. The Developers were responsible for building and testing the application. I think having these responsibilities clearly defined helped prevent confusion because everyone understood what they needed to contribute. It also made it easier for the team to work toward the same goal.

One thing I learned from the SNHU Travel project was how useful user stories are during development. Instead of giving developers a long list of instructions, user stories explain what a customer wants to accomplish and why it matters. I think this makes it easier for the development team to understand what they are creating.

During the course, I worked with user stories and learned how they could be organized into a product backlog. The backlog helped identify which features needed attention first. I also learned that acceptance criteria are important because they explain what needs to happen for a user story to be considered complete. This gives developers and testers a clearer understanding of what is expected. Overall, I think user stories make the development process more organized because the team can focus on smaller tasks instead of trying to complete everything at once.

Another important part of Agile development is being able to handle changes. In a traditional development approach, making changes after a project has already started can create problems because the team may be following a fixed plan. With Scrum, changes can be reviewed and prioritized as the project moves forward.

In the SNHU Travel project, I learned that customer needs can change during development. When this happens, the Product Owner can review the new requirements and update the product backlog. The team can then discuss how those changes affect future work. I think this is a better approach than continuing with a feature that no longer meets the customer's needs. Changes can still cause delays, but Scrum gives the team a way to respond without completely restarting the project.

Communication was one of the biggest things I learned about during this course. I originally thought software development involved mostly independent work, but I now understand how important it is for team members to communicate regularly. Even when everyone is completing their own responsibilities, problems can happen if they aren't sharing updates.

Daily Scrum meetings are one way teams can stay informed about their progress. These meetings give Developers an opportunity to discuss their work, identify problems, and adjust their plans. I

also think communication between the Product Owner and Developers is important because it helps make sure the application meets customer expectations.

In the SNHU Travel project, the different Scrum roles showed me how communication connects everyone involved in development. I learned that asking questions, sharing progress, and addressing problems early can help prevent larger issues later. I would rather work with a team that communicates regularly than one where everyone works separately without knowing what others are doing.

I think organizational tools are especially helpful when multiple people are working on the same project. A product backlog allows the team to keep track of requirements, while a Sprint Backlog helps Developers organize the work they plan to complete during a Sprint. Task boards can also show which tasks haven't been started, which are in progress, and which are finished.

Scrum events also help the team stay organized. Sprint Planning gives the team an opportunity to decide what work should be completed. The Daily Scrum helps Developers inspect their progress. The Sprint Review allows the team and stakeholders to look at what was completed and discuss possible changes. The Sprint Retrospective gives the team a chance to reflect on how they worked together and identify improvements.

I think the Sprint Retrospective is especially useful because it focuses on improving the team's process instead of only looking at the finished product. If something caused confusion or slowed down development, the team can discuss what happened and decide how to handle it differently next time. This can help the team become more productive during future Sprints.

After learning about the different software development approaches, I think Scrum was a good choice for the SNHU Travel project. One of its biggest advantages is flexibility. Since customer expectations and project requirements can change, having the ability to make adjustments throughout development is important.

Another advantage is that Scrum breaks development into smaller Sprints. Instead of waiting until the entire application is finished, the team can review completed work and receive feedback throughout the project. This makes it easier to identify problems early and make improvements before moving forward.

However, Scrum also has disadvantages. It requires consistent communication, participation, and organization. If team members aren't keeping up with their responsibilities or communicating changes, it can affect the entire team. Scrum also depends on having a Product Owner who can prioritize requirements and help the team understand what customers need.

Overall, I believe Scrum was the better approach for the SNHU Travel project because the application needed to respond to customer feedback and changing requirements. A Waterfall approach might have worked if all requirements were clearly defined from the beginning and unlikely to change. However, I think the flexibility and regular feedback provided by Scrum made it more appropriate for this project.

This course helped me understand that software development involves more than just programming. I learned how Scrum roles, user stories, communication, and organizational tools all contribute to creating a successful application. I also learned that being able to respond to changes is an important part of the development process. The SNHU Travel project gave me a

better understanding of how an Agile team works together, and I think the skills I learned will be useful when working on software projects in the future.